

BHUVAN BAM, 27

YouTuber/ actor/ singer

WHAM BAM

In 2015, when Bhuvan Bam began exploring a career as an entertainer on YouTube, friends and relatives laughed him off. But with 24.2 million subscribers for his YouTube channel BB ki Vines, a hit web series (*Dhindora*), a merchandise brand (Youthiapa), a short film (*Plus Minus*) and multiple interviews with stars under his belt, Bam is having the last laugh.

"I want to be known as an entertainer. The social media star and influencer tag does not have as much appeal"

He is a clear example of the ability of video streaming to empower creators. Bam's success comes courtesy his ability to develop a range of characters, many of whom are drawn from real life. Having grown up on the comedy of Govinda and Kader Khan, Bam focuses on the mundane, the little things that make his humour relatable. The sum of his talents, though, is best visible in *Dhindora*, an eight-episode series he has created, co-written and in which he plays 10 characters. ■

–Suhani Singh

LONELY TUNES Before becoming a YouTuber, Bam used to sing six days a week, four hours a day at a restaurant in south Delhi

THE GAME CHANGER

DHANUSH, 38

Actor/ singer/ director

Dhanush has been at the top of his game for more than 10 years now. He found almost instant success with his second film, *Kaadhal Kondein*, directed by his brother, director Selvaraghavan. Except for a brief lull in the late 2000s when he was still in search of his niche, he's not had a period when he wasn't in the conversation with a truly original film. He may not have the market of his peers Ajith and Vijay, but his success is measured by his roles and collaborations



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